



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 396

LCO No. 2037



Referred to Committee on HIGHER EDUCATION AND
EMPLOYMENT ADVANCEMENT

Introduced by:
(HED)

***AN ACT PERMITTING NINETY-CREDIT DEGREE PROGRAMS AT
INSTITUTIONS OF HIGHER EDUCATION IN THE STATE.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General
Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 10a-34 of the general statutes is amended by adding
2 subsection (m) as follows (*Effective July 1, 2026*):

3 (NEW) (m) The Office of Higher Education shall permit institutions
4 of higher education in the state to submit an application for a new
5 degree program through which a degree may be earned after the
6 completion of not fewer than ninety credit hours, provided such
7 program has accreditation recognized by the Secretary of the United
8 States Department of Education. The office shall conduct a review of
9 each application submitted under this subsection pursuant to the
10 provisions of this section, including, but not limited to, a focused or on-
11 site review, when necessary.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following
sections:

Section 1	<i>July 1, 2026</i>	10a-34(m)
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Statement of Purpose:

To permit ninety-credit degree programs at institutions of higher education.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]